be the centre of attention. Kevin wanted to be the big shot, the star on centre stage. There's nothing wrong with that. It's just what makes him tick.

He's the actor who wants to be in the spotlight, delivering booming lines and memorable speeches. I was happy to be the stage assistant. That's why our partnership worked so well. People with his capacity to dominate an occasion are few and far between. They are invaluable when they are fully focused.

The disparity in our philosophies of life was underlined by the subsequent week off, in Melbourne. I asked to play in a low-key two-day game at the MCG, because I wanted to maintain the synchronization of my batting. I was in the form of my life, and Goochy reinforced the value of simply hitting the ball, to keep the rhythm going. Flower readily excused me from fielding duties.

KP was certainly different. He hired a lime green Lamborghini, which he parked outside the Langham Hotel. I am a bit of a car nut but would be wary of Mother Cricket biting me on the arse for having the nerve to do that. I loved KP for doing so. The last thing I would want to do is shout about a double hundred; he drove around town in a motor that demanded attention.

In his brightest moments he had a zest for cricket, for living to the max. I still smile when I recall his childish glee at taking a rare Test wicket, with the final delivery of the fourth day at Adelaide. I caught Michael Clarke, going backwards from short leg, and KP nearly flattened me with the ferocity of his embrace. It was like being hit in the midriff by a tightly packed hay bale.

That Adelaide Test revealed other aspects of character. Straussy shielded us from the worst of the weather forecasts on the final day: the ground was under water within an hour of Swanny guaranteeing victory by bowling beautifully on a turning wicket. The Barmy Army, congregated around the scoreboard, went, well, barmy.

They were unaware of the background to another definitive performance by Stuart Broad, who bowled in the first innings with a two-inch tear in a side muscle. The public perception of him as an impossibly handsome, occasionally petulant, preening blond couldn't be further from the truth. He is as tough as they come; that act of self-sacrifice put him out for two months.